

“The independence of a community is important for a successful open source project”



Radhika Samant, CFO, EnterpriseDB

Q When should an IT manager ideally think about open source technology?

Today, a major concern for IT managers is their budget constraints. Open source has been around for a while and Red Hat has a huge success story to support that. In the database space, open source is beginning to gain a lot of momentum right now across the globe and is building a base for itself in the government space, in Fortune 500 companies, et al. We see open source databases being adopted by a wide range of users who are looking at it as a means of reducing their budgetary requirements as well as from a control standpoint. They now want to really go away from the excessively

There is no harm if a company works closely with the open source community, but if it starts dominating the community...that could be detrimental. EnterpriseDB believes in this philosophy to the core and the results can be seen in the success of PostgreSQL as a database. **Diksha P Gupta from Open Source For You spoke to Radhika Samant, CFO, EnterpriseDB** on what it takes to maintain the right balance between a company and an open source community. Excerpts of the conversation are shared here.

proprietary infrastructure and get into an open source domain where they can have better control. Yet another thing that I want to highlight is the *concept* of open source. One can't really adopt open source in a mission critical or, for that matter, a non-mission critical environment without a big company supporting it. In the database space, with Postgres being such a good contender, there is a huge demand and EnterpriseDB is emerging as that leader. It is opening up a whole new opportunity for IT professionals to look at and a whole new way to think about databases.

Q Of course one cannot deny that PostgreSQL is emerging as one of the most competitive players. At one point in time, Monty Widenius, founder of MySQL, said "...it's time to seriously review how MySQL server is being developed and change the development model to be more like ...PostgreSQL." What do you think could have prompted him to make a statement like that?

The PostgreSQL community is remarkably strong and independent with many developers and companies supporting the creation of the technology. This fosters a very healthy open source project. It removes the possibility of an acquisition of a particular company or the possibility of taking away the independent nature of that database. Just like Linux, this makes PostgreSQL a more compelling and attractive technology for business' and government to use.

Q What do you think are the basic differences between the two development models of MySQL and PostgreSQL?

The most obvious and important difference is that the MySQL brand was predominantly owned and managed by a single company. The community of contributors